



Review: Further Light on Vatican Council II

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REVIEW ARTICLE

FURTHER LIGHT ON VATICAN COUNCIL II

BY

JARED WICKS, S.J.*

Carnets du Concile. By Henri de Lubac. Edited and annotated by Loïc Figoureux. 2 vols. (Paris: Éditions du Cerf. 2007. Vol. 1: Pp. 1, 567, €39,00 paperback, ISBN 978-2-204-08528-1. Vol. 2: Pp. 569, €36,00 paperback, ISBN 978-2-204-08529-8. Vols. 1 and 2: €75,00.)

Vatican II: A Sociological Analysis of Religious Change. By Melissa J. Wilde. (Princeton: Princeton University Press. 2007. Pp. xv, 196. \$38.50. ISBN 978-0-691-11829-1.)

Vatican II. Herméneutique et réception. By Gilles Routhier. [Collection Héritage et projet, 69.] (Montréal: Éditions Fides. 2006. Pp. 468. C\$39.95 paperback. ISBN 978-2-762-12685-3.)

This review article continues two earlier discussions of recent publications of sources and studies on Vatican Council II.¹ Presented here are (1) the personal diary kept from 1960 to 1965 by *peritus* Henri de Lubac, (2) a sociological study of how the Council came to make its major interventions favoring change in the Church, and (3) a collection of studies and reflections on the Catholic Church's reception over forty years of Vatican II.

The Vatican II Diary of Henri de Lubac (1896–1991)

The existence of de Lubac's Council diary² had been known, but few scholars had access to it, whether in the handwritten original or in the typed

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¹"New Light on Vatican Council II," *The Catholic Historical Review*, 92 (2006), 609–28, and "More Light on Vatican Council II," *The Catholic Historical Review*, 94 (2008), 75–101. Massimo Faggioli offers an ample survey of three years of recent work in all languages in "Council Vatican II: Bibliographical Overview 2005–2007," *Cristianesimo nella storia*, 24 (2008), 567–610.

²Leo Kenis treated the importance of personal diaries in historically oriented Vatican II studies at the 2005 congress held in Mechelen, Leuven, and Louvain-la-Neuve. See his "Diaries. Private Sources for a Study of the Second Vatican Council," in *The*

text dating from the early 1980s.³ The published text now offers testimony that pinpoints problematic aspects of the Council's doctrinal preparation, with de Lubac's astute perceptions of conciliar action during the four working periods and his critical views, late in the Council, about how the Church should engage in dialogue with the world.⁴

1. Problems in Vatican II's Doctrinal Preparatory Work

In 1960 de Lubac was appointed, along with Father Yves Marie Joseph Congar, O.P., to work as a consultor of Vatican II's Preparatory Theological Commission. In this appointment de Lubac saw an indication by Pope John XXIII that it was time to set aside the Vatican difficulties of the early 1950s over theological opinions of certain French Jesuits and Dominicans.⁵ The

Belgian Contribution to the Second Vatican Council, ed. Doris Donnelly, Joseph Famerée, Mathijs Lamberigts, and Karim Schelkens, [Bibliotheca Ephemeridum Theologicarum Lovaniensium, 216], (Leuven, 2008), pp. 29–53.

³Philippe Levillain used the original notebooks to good effect but preserved de Lubac's anonymity by citing them as *documents inédits* or *documents privés* throughout *Le mécanisme politique de Vatican II: la majorité et l'unanimité dans un concile* (Paris, 1975). Karl H. Neufeld did not draw on the diary for his surveys, "In the Service of the Council. Bishops and Theologians at the Second Vatican Council," in *Vatican II: Assessment and Perspectives*, ed. René Latourelle, 3 vols. (New York, 1988), 1:74–105, esp. 88–98, and "Henri de Lubac S.J. als Konzilstheologe," *Theologisch-praktische Quartalschrift*, 134 (1996), 149–59. Giuseppe Ruggieri drew on the unpublished *Carnets* to document de Lubac's perceptions of what were for him disturbing currents circulating during 1964–65, in "Delusioni alla fine del concilio. Qualche atteggiamento nell'ambiente cattolico francese," in *Volti di fine concilio. Studi di storia e teologia sulla conclusione del Vaticano II*, ed. Joseph Doré and Alberto Melloni (Bologna, 2000), pp. 193–224, esp. pp. 207–18. Alexandra von Teuffenbach cited sixteen passages from early parts of de Lubac's diary in notes on Tromp's record of the work of the Preparatory Theological Commission; see Tromp's *Diarium Secretarii, Konzilstagebuch, mit Erläuterungen und Akten aus der Arbeit der Theologischen Kommission. II. Vatikanisches Konzil*, ed. Alexandra von Teuffenbach, vol. I/1–2 (1960–62) (Rome, 2006), pp. 503–66.

⁴Neufeld, in "H. de Lubac als Konzilstheologe," recalls that before the Council, de Lubac published major works on several topics taken up at Vatican II, such as ecclesiology renewed from early sources, Eucharist and Church, modern atheism, the graced human vocation, and the Christian relation to Buddhism.

⁵*At the Service of the Church. Henri de Lubac Reflects on the Circumstances That Occasioned His Writings*, trans. Anne E. Englund (San Francisco, 1993), p. 116, where de Lubac notes that shortly after becoming pope, John XXIII made a large donation to support Sources chrétiennes, the patristic editions directed by de Lubac and Jean Daniélou, and he sent de Lubac a warm personal letter. The pope knew of the "difficulties" from his service as papal nuncio in Paris from 1944 to 1953. In 1952, a visitor found Nuncio Roncalli with a copy in his hand of Congar's *Vraie et fausse réforme dans l'Église* (Paris, 1953). Congar heard this in 1965 and recorded it in his Vatican II diary (*Mon Journal du Concile* [Paris, 2002], 2:441–42).

Preparatory Commission prepared seven doctrinal and moral draft texts in 1960–62, which in time met incisive criticism by the Council's majority.⁶ About the preparatory work, de Lubac wrote later that a complete chronicle "would not be lacking in picturesque scenes," but such a chronicle will probably not be written "since most of the participants would have no desire to transmit the memory of it to posterity."⁷

Among the scenes of 1960, de Lubac recorded meeting Joaquin Salaverri, S.J., a consultant from Madrid, at the Biblical Institute and candidly telling Salaverri how mistaken he had been about the Jesuit theologate of Fourvière in his critical articles of 1949–51. On November 15, 1960, de Lubac went to the Holy Office, where he met another consultant, Father Marie-Michel Labourdette, O.P., who had in 1946 criticized the Fourvière Jesuits (de Lubac, Jean Daniélou, Henri Bouillard, Gaston Fessard, and Hans Urs von Balthasar) with an article in *Revue Thomiste* on theology and its sources. Shortly afterward, de Lubac knelt before Cardinal Alfredo Ottaviani, who sat between two lighted candles with the book of Gospels in his lap, and took an oath to keep the preparatory work secret.⁸

Beyond picturesque scenes, de Lubac's diary describes the commission's controlling mentality, which clashed with convictions underlying de Lubac's own work of thirty years for theological *ressourcement*. His Belgian confrere and redactor of the commission's texts on revelation and faith, Edouard Dhanis of the Gregorian, "has no sense of the simple grandeur of the faith of the Church that we proclaim, and strangely diminishes faith in Jesus Christ."

⁶On the commission: Riccardo Burigana, "Progetto dogmatico del Vaticano II: la commissione teologica preparatoria (1960–1962)," in *Verso il Concilio Vaticano II (1960–1962). Passaggi e problemi della preparazione conciliare*, ed. Giuseppe Alberigo and Alberto Melloni (Genoa, 1993), pp. 141–206.

⁷*At the Service of the Church*, p. 117. The preparation brought de Lubac to Rome four times for a total of forty days of commission meetings, as related in *Carnets du Concile*, 1:7–88. Congar's diary for this period is of the same length (*Mon Journal du Concile*, 1:15–97).

⁸*Carnets du Concile*, 1:12 (meeting Salaverri), p. 13 (with Labourdette), and p. 14 (taking the oath). On Salaverri's critiques and on several other publications indicated in de Lubac's diary, the edition does not furnish references. Labourdette's 1946 criticism, targeting the series *Sources chrétiennes* and the series *Théologie*, which Réginald Garrigou-Lagrange soon took to a more threatening level, was treated by Étienne Fouilloux in "Dialogue théologique? (1946–1948)," in *Saint Thomas au XX^e siècle. Colloque du centenaire de la Revue thomiste* (Paris, 1994), pp. 153–95. Because of his oath of secrecy, de Lubac recorded in his diary few notes that illuminate the genesis of the Preparatory Commission's schemata. But von Teuffenbach's edition of Tromp's office diary, in the pages indicated above in n. 3, lists nine written comments that de Lubac handed in on draft chapters of the commission's doctrinal schemata. Congar's diary is more informative in areas such as the initial make-up of subcommissions for four schemata and the highlights of the plenary meeting of September 18–28, 1961 (*Mon Journal*, 1:34–36, 60–79).

Those overseeing the drafting of the schemata manifested negativity, a low intellectual level, and mean-spiritedness, while possessing little sense of the world that awaits the Gospel, as shown in the November 1960 public lecture by Monsignor Antonio Piolanti, the Lateran University rector, who called on the Council to condemn French Catholic neo-modernist theology by ratifying tenets of Pope Pius IX's *Syllabus of Errors* (1864) and Pope Pius XII's *Humani generis* (1950).⁹

According to de Lubac and Congar, the draft schemata came from men who seemed indifferent to Scripture, the Fathers, and the Eastern tradition, as well as unconcerned over modern currents of thought hostile to Christian faith. They privileged judgment and a small system of certitudes to the neglect of an understanding that could nourish believers and attract the world to the Gospel. They did not speak about central dogmas and the Christian mystery in its deep unity, as they pulverized it into assertions resting on magisterial texts of the past century. They worked energetically on issues of church government, but only superficially on the mystery of faith. These men were fixated on recent papal texts, which they patched together in draft texts that they wanted the Council to proclaim as the present-day faith.¹⁰

In the early phase of Vatican II doctrinal preparation, de Lubac clashed with his Jesuit confrere Dhanis over the latter's formulation of a censure of ideas of Pierre Teilhard de Chardin in draft chapters on creation and original

⁹*Carnets du Concile*, 1:21 (on Dhanis, November 19, 1960), p. 22 (Piolanti's address), and p. 24n4 (letter of the same day mentioning Piolanti). Dhanis and Piolanti were not consultants but members of the Preparatory Commission. From the latter, see "Magistero della chiesa e la scienza teologica," *Divinitas*, 5 (1961), 531–51, which cites deviations from the *Syllabus* and *Humani generis* in works by Bouillard, von Balthasar, Chenu, Daniélou, and de Lubac in *Surnaturel* (1946), *Corpus mysticum* (1949), and "Le mystère du surnaturel" (*Recherches de science religieuse*, 36 [1949], 80–121). The address corresponds to Piolanti's chapter on theology and the magisterium in the Lateran University's voluminous *votum* on topics for the Council submitted during the pre-preparatory canvas of 1959–60 (*Acta et Documenta Concilii Oecumenici Vaticani II Apparando*, ser. I [Antepreparatoria], IV/1/1:248–63). The Sacred Congregation on Seminaries took over Piolanti's text and, after dropping references by name to theologians and their works, submitted it as its own Council *votum* (*Acta et Documenta*, ser. I, III:321–28).

¹⁰*Carnets du Concile*, 1:34–36 (generalization of September 19–20, 1961), pp. 53–54 (typology dividing theologians between those immersed in the sources and those knitting together patches from recent encyclicals), and pp. 85–87 (final reflection on March 12, 1962, after sessions on the schema *De ecclesia*). De Lubac's typology of theologians anticipates Philips's statement, based on the preparation and beginning of Vatican II, "Deux tendances dans la théologie contemporaine," *Nouvelle Revue Théologique*, 85 (1963), 225–38. Congar framed his general assessment in August 1961 in a manner resembling de Lubac's analysis, while adding that the draft texts endangered any realization of John XXIII's objective of promoting ecumenical reconciliation (*Mon Journal*, 1:57–59).

sin in the schema on guarding the deposit of faith. At the time de Lubac had begun, under commission from his Jesuit superiors, his first book-length apologia for Teilhard, and he argued vigorously, in February 1961, in defense of Teilhard against Dhanis and Piolanti before the whole commission. Bishop Albert Stohr of Mainz intervened in support of Teilhard, and Monsignor Gérard Philips proposed a vote that showed a majority of commission members wanting to drop the anti-Teilhard passage. But in September 1961 the passage was still in the text, and de Lubac saw no mention of his own written interventions in the *relatio* explaining the September text.¹¹

A second clash broke out over Dhanis's draft text on God's revelation, prepared for chapter IV of the schema on the deposit of faith. Dhanis presented this to the commission on September 22, 1961, and de Lubac immediately recognized two passages that in effect censured ideas proposed in his own writings.¹² Treating the way in which God's revelation attains its fullness in Christ, no. 20 insisted that nonetheless divine and Catholic faith is in itself assent to revealed truths and so must not be explained as a first intuitive experience of all revelation in the mystery of Christ, from which believers pass on to expressions of this in concepts and terms.¹³ No. 22 censured "a recent form of relativism"—namely, the idea that in revealed truths the propositions and concepts are only approximations that are incapable of declaring

¹¹*Carnets du Concile*, 1:31 ("un rude combat" with Piolanti and Dhanis, February 16, 1961), p. 37 (recalling, on September 21, 1961, Stohr's earlier support and sharp rebuke of Dhanis and Piolanti, "Ne quid nimis!"), and pp. 39–40 (recalling the February vote and noting the disregard of his texts giving passages of Teilhard saying the opposite of what the text censured). Stohr died in June 1961. In October 1961 de Lubac completed the manuscript of *La pensée religieuse du père Pierre Teilhard de Chardin* (Paris, 1961), translated as *The Religion of Teilhard de Chardin* (New York, 1967). De Lubac relates his series of pro-Teilhard projects in *At the Service of the Church*, pp. 103–12 (narration) and pp. 323–36 (documents).

¹²*Carnets du Concile*, 1:37 (the September 22 meeting: "À deux reprises, ce texte contient un passage destiné à me faire condamner par le concile."). Congar heard from de Lubac how deeply upsetting it was to be attacked in a text meant for the Council (*Mon Journal*, 1:77–78, entry of September 28). The passages are in *Acta Synodalia Concilii Oecumenici Vaticani Secundi*, I/4:664, 665. The genesis of *De deposito*, chap. IV, on revelation, was studied by Brendan Cahill in *The Renewal of Revelation Theology (1960–1962). The Development and Responses to the Fourth Chapter of the Preparatory Schema De deposito Fidei* (Rome, 1999), offering chap. IV in Latin and English on pp. 266–91.

¹³This opposes what de Lubac wrote in "Le Problème du développement du dogme," *Recherches de science religieuse*, 35 (1948), 130–60, at 156–58 on the mystery of Christ as primary in faith and as "le Tout du dogme." A reprint is in the collection *Théologie dans l'histoire* (Paris, 1990), pp. 38–70, translated in *Theology in History* (San Francisco, 1996), pp. 248–80 (n.b. pp. 273–76). In explaining *De deposito*, no. 20, in 1962, Smulders saw the passage targeting a similar idea expressed by Karl Rahner. See my "Pieter Smulders and *Dei Verbum*: 1. A Consultation on the Eve of Vatican II," *Gregorianum*, 82 (2001), 241–97, esp. 276–78 and 296–97.

divine realities and so must be subject to ongoing correction and change.¹⁴ Later information confirmed de Lubac's belief that Dhanis wrote these censorious passages of the schema because they agreed with what the latter had had included in the Gregorian theology faculty's antepreparatory proposal of topics for the Council.¹⁵

Dhanis rebuffed de Lubac's request for a fraternal discussion on revelation and dogmatic terminology, so the accused applied to the commission's secretary, Father Sebastiaan Tromp, S.J., with the demand for a clarification. If this were not forthcoming, said de Lubac, he would resign from the commission, since he could not serve if the commission was going to judge his writings as doctrinally deviant.¹⁶ The drama of this exchange intensified on September 26, 1961, when de Lubac attended a session of a congress on St. Paul held in Rome and heard Dom Christopher Butler speak on St. Paul's notion of faith, which in Butler's view bore an uncanny resemblance to the conception that Dhanis's text intended to declare erroneous, but that, for de Lubac, was the center of Christian faith.¹⁷

Butler, along with other biblical experts, was a glimmer of hope for the coming Council. In addition, de Lubac met individuals in 1960–62 quite different from those dominating the drafting of doctrinal schemata. Congar was

¹⁴In *Carnets du Concile*, 1:51, de Lubac says he had seen this accusation ten years before, in pages sent to him by the Jesuit father general as a consultor's view that the father general should not allow de Lubac to publish the essay now accessible as "La doctrine du Père Lebreton sur la Révélation et le dogme d'après ses écrits antimodernistes," in *Théologie dans l'histoire*, pp. 108–56; translated in *Theology in History*, pp. 317–66. Dhanis served Father General John Baptist Janssens, S.J., as counselor on issues of theology by French Jesuits.

¹⁵In November 1960, Henri Vignon of the Gregorian showed de Lubac passages resembling nos. 20 and 22 of *De deposito* that were Dhanis's contribution to the Gregorian University's antepreparatory *votum* for the Council. On September 28, 1961, de Lubac made his own copy of this early form of the censures (*Carnets*, 1:21, 51–52). These parts of the Gregorian proposal are in *Acta et Documenta* (as in n. 9, above), ser. I, IV/1:11–13.

¹⁶*Carnets du Concile*, 1:40 (Dhanis's refusal), p. 50n1 (letter to Tromp), p. 55 (Tromp's oral assurance that de Lubac was not targeted in the passages), and p. 56n3 (Tromp's written response regarding the commission, which calmed de Lubac somewhat, but did not convince him about Dhanis's aim and intent). Later, on March 2, 1963, de Lubac heard from Tromp that the question was moot, because the Coordinating Commission had removed the schema *De deposito fidei* from the Council's agenda (*Carnets*, 1:545).

¹⁷*Carnets du Concile*, 1:42–43. De Lubac's further notes during Vatican II's four periods record several sound interventions by Butler, who joined the Council's Doctrinal Commission at the end of Period II. Butler's 1961 lecture was "The Object of Faith according to St. Paul's Letters," published in *Studiorum Paulinorum Congressus Internationalis Catholicus 1961*, 2 vols., [Analecta Biblica, 17–18], (Rome, 1963), 1:15–30.

an ally from the beginning. Cardinal Augustin Bea held promise for the Council. Father Bernard Häring made good interventions, such as highlighting charity in the moral schemata. Philips was effective in moderating otherwise severe texts because of his source-based theology and calm demeanor. Bishop James Griffiths, auxiliary of New York, made brief but memorable cautionary statements against the Roman theologians, and Maxim Hermaniuk, C.Ss.R., the Ukrainian-born bishop of Winnipeg, spoke effectively on the episcopate to counter exaggerated accounts of the papal magisterium. On the horizon, briefly noted, was the Council's Central Preparatory Commission with its outspoken cardinals and archbishops (Bea, Franz König, Josef Frings, Bernard Alfrink, Julius August Döpfner, Paul-Émile Léger, Denis Hurley, and similar individuals) who in November 1961 began subjecting the prepared doctrinal drafts to incisive negative criticism.¹⁸

2. Insights amidst Daily Life at Vatican II

De Lubac wrote later that his role during the Council “was not considerable,” but limited to attending meetings of the Doctrinal Commission; to many conversations with bishops; and to conferences for groups of bishops in which he could tell them, for example, about the “not very happy” work of the Preparatory Theological Commission. In drafting the Council's texts, he contributed only a few details.¹⁹ Nonetheless, de Lubac's *Carnets* offer many astute remarks on Vatican II events and personages.

Like other diaries of *periti*, de Lubac's contains notes made in St. Peter's on the Fathers' discourses, but there are also judgments and points of background. Cardinal Eugene Tisserant informed the Fathers on October 24, 1962, about several Vatican-approved, Roman-rite missals in different vernacular languages (Slavonic, Croatian, Syriac), in a “dryly delivered, precise, and erudite” talk of ten minutes without a wasted word. Two days later, the Dutch bishop Willem Bekkers pointed out that most objections to the liturgy draft

¹⁸Before the preparation began, Congar visited de Lubac in Lyon to strategize (*Mon Journal*, 1:21–22). In *Carnets du Concile*, de Lubac mentioned his positive impressions of Bea (1:16), Häring (pp. 40–41, 79), Philips (pp. 66, 70–71), Griffiths (p. 70, on the Spirit of Pentecost not coming down on the Roman theologians, and p. 74, on avoiding a new Galileo case regarding overpopulation), Hermaniuk (p. 68), and the Central Preparatory Commission (pp. 61–62). Congar recorded how Ottaviani told the Theological Commission on March 5, 1962, about the Central Commission's chilly reception of the theological schemata, to which Congar added that this was understandable because the texts exuded the atmosphere of the Holy Office and that the Central Commission could be anticipating how the full Council would, in time, judge these texts (*Mon Journal*, 1:88–89).

¹⁹Letter to Hubert Schnackers, given in *At the Service of the Church* (as in n. 5, above), p. 362. The letter would be from around 1975, when Schnackers was in doctoral studies at Regensburg. His dissertation is *Kirche als Sacrament und Mutter: zur Ekklesiologie von Henri de Lubac* (Frankfurt am Main, 1978).

were coming from Council members speaking only for themselves, whereas several who praised the draft spoke in the name of whole episcopates. On November 14, 1962, the first day of interventions on *De fontibus revelationis*, Archbishop Gabriel Manek made, on behalf of the bishops of Indonesia, an incisive case against the schema, in which de Lubac identified arguments drawn up by *peritus* Piet Smulders in a text that had been circulating. But two days later, Bishop Émile Guerry of Cambrai descended to the level of an imprecise *ferverino* and concluded in an ambiguous manner that would encourage partisans of *De fontibus*. De Lubac added what he heard the next day about the dissatisfaction of many French bishops with Guerry.²⁰

On December 2, 1963, on the Marian chapter of *De ecclesia*, General Secretary Pericle Felici and Cardinal Ernesto Ruffini both spoke of going “to God through Mary,” showing no sense that all Christian prayer has a trinitarian shape and is through Jesus Christ. Cardinal Leo Jozef Suenens’s intervention on Mary on September 17, 1964, was simplistic in doctrine and tended to promote an activist spirituality.²¹ On October 26, 1964, when Dom Jean Prou, abbot of Solesmes, criticized Schema XIII, he had in mind Teilhard, but wrongly so. His real target was an unfortunate amalgamation of Church and world proposed by *periti* Marie-Dominique Chenu and Edward Schillebeeckx. On September 24, 1965, Cardinal Frings and Bishop Hermann Volk mounted “the German offensive” against doctrinal lacunae in the revised Schema XIII, making points that are “*justes et capitales*,” but what influence can they have on the incompetent and superficial backers of the draft?²²

De Lubac’s *Carnets* contain notes taken at meetings, especially of the Council’s Doctrinal Commission, of which the minutes are not in Vatican II’s *Acta Synodalia*. On November 18, 1962, he recorded proposals advanced at a session convened by Volk of mainly French and German members and *periti* to plan alternatives to the doctrinal schemata on revelation and the deposit of faith. De Lubac, on October 11, 1963, recorded how the Doctrinal Commission reviewed an early draft on religious liberty. From the second intersession, the diary offers an ample record of the same commission’s review, on June 1–6, 1964, of its subcommissions’ revised drafts on the Blessed

²⁰*Carnets du Concile*, 1:153, 163, 284, and 302.

²¹*Carnets du Concile*, 2:54, 121. On September 28, 1965, a long conversation with Suenens left de Lubac saddened over the cardinal’s superficiality, pretensions, and lack of awareness of the spread of atheism (2:418–19). An ample account of the cardinal’s Council roles and interventions, along with his interactions with other leading figures (John XXIII, Döpfner, Lercaro, Dossetti, Montini/Paul VI, and Léger), can be found in six papers of *The Belgian Contribution to the Second Vatican Council* (as in n. 2, above), pp. 59–357.

²²*Carnets du Concile*, 2:251, 414. Three days after Frings and Volk spoke, de Lubac read the critical written observations on the draft of Schema XIII by the German and Scandinavian bishops, adding his regret that the French bishops never produce work like this, in spite of their real but often unenlightened pastoral zeal (2:417).

Virgin, revelation and tradition, episcopal collegiality (including treatment of suggestions from Pope Paul VI), and matrimony. The *Carnets* for Period III (1964) include notes made both during the Doctrinal Commission's methodical and often tense treatment of the final *modi* on *De ecclesia* and during the Mixed Commission's work to revise Schema XIII after its first discussion in the Aula. From Period IV de Lubac gives details of six hours of meetings on November 23, 1965, at which the Mixed Commission dealt with the *modi* generated during voting on the schema on the Church in the modern world.²³

Accounts of Vatican II commonly highlight the conferences given by *periti* to update the bishops on theological and biblical topics. De Lubac's diary indicates that he gave fifteen such conferences, especially during Periods I and IV, to the bishops of France, Madagascar and francophone Africa, and Argentina, and to Brazilians and others at Domus Mariae.²⁴ The topics reflect the movement of the Council from early critiques of the prepared texts *De fontibus* and *De deposito fidei* to later accounts of nature and the supernatural in relation to Schema XIII. De Lubac notes giving just as many talks to seminarians and graduate students in Rome at national colleges (French, Belgian, English, and Portuguese) and religious houses (Holy Cross, Jesuit, and Salesian). In these, he treated the Creed early on, but in 1965 took up *Dei Verbum* as foundational in renewal.²⁵ In Rome, Florence, Bologna, and Milan, de Lubac lectured during the Council's Periods, especially on Teilhard.²⁶

²³*Carnets du Concile*, 1:322–29 (at Volk's meeting, de Lubac expressed pessimism about reaching any understanding with the Ottaviani-Tromp group, but Philips observed that the first month of the Council had made them less assured, while Rahner urged all to be ready to join in revising the preparatory schemata, except the impossible *De deposito fidei*, by tenacious preparation, line by line, of reformulations); 2:20–26 (October 11, 1963, where Griffiths insisted on the issue being *immunitas a coactione* and that John XXIII had said in *Pacem in terris* what the draft proposes; later, J. C. Murray made an excellent point); pp. 63–105 (June 1964; on Paul VI's suggestions, given as an appendix to the *Carnets* [2:506–09], but no reference to this appendix occurs in the text; pp. 85–100, that records the discussion and voting on them); pp. 227, 237–62 (determinations on *modi* on *De ecclesia*); pp. 316–18 (on Schema XIII, where disorder reigns because the co-chairs, Cardinals Ottaviani and Cento, are incompetent and tolerate airy discourses but cut off good interventions, like one by McGrath); and pp. 462–63 (six hours on the *modi* offered for the atheism section; doctrinal incompetence abounded, but Cardinal Franjo Šeper of Zagreb combined good sense with moderation).

²⁴De Lubac's Vatican II work with the bishops of France was not extensive. He noted that he had no part in their organized preparations of interventions and no regular contact with Archbishop Gabriel-Marie Garrone, the French member of the Doctrinal Commission (November 26, 1963; *Carnets du Concile*, 2:48). Congar lamented that the French bishops were not profiting from de Lubac's considerable stature as a theologian in their Council work (note of October 15, 1964; *Mon Journal*, 2:205). But de Lubac's own lament, late in Vatican II, was that no one had thought to involve von Balthasar: "The Church thus deprived itself of its best theologian" (November 11, 1965; *Carnets* 2:456).

The *Carnets* refer to three moments in which de Lubac sought to influence the development of what became the Pastoral Constitution on the Church in the Modern World, *Gaudium et spes*. At a meeting of the responsible commission (combined from the Doctrinal and Lay Apostolate commissions), de Lubac gave Bishop Marcos McGrath on June 5, 1964, some pages expressing his dissatisfaction with an early draft drawn up mainly by Häring. McGrath gave the text to Häring, who asked de Lubac the next day to help revise and further develop the text.²⁷ In September 1964 de Lubac participated in a workshop of French bishops and *periti* that met twice to evaluate the previously distributed text of Schema XIII that was soon to be discussed in the Aula. The *Carnets* include de Lubac's critical letter written between the two meetings on the present schema's timidity and unfocused ideas of nature and the supernatural. The text needs "apostolic audacity." The diary also gives his notes on proposals at the second meeting; de Lubac spoke last, calling for a text that spoke from the start out of Christian hope and, while light on doctrine, would still exude the conviction that Christianity carries in itself the truth necessary for life in this world.²⁸

²⁵The 1962 talks were developing parts of *La Foi chrétienne* (1969), translated as *The Christian Faith: An Essay on the Structure of the Apostles' Creed* (San Francisco, 1986). At the end of the Council, de Lubac was glad to write on *Dei Verbum*, both briefly in his preface to the commentary by Roger Schutz and Max Thurian (in French, 1966), translated as *Revelation: A Protestant View* (Westminster, MD, 1968), and more fully in his commentary on DV, nos. 1–6, in *La Révélation divine*, ed. B.-D. Dupuy, [Unam sanctam 70], (Paris, 1968). This commentary was published separately as *Dieu se dit dans l'histoire* (1974) and, with additions, as *La Révélation divine*, [Traditions chrétiennes], (Paris, 1983). On the last page of the *Carnets*, de Lubac recorded speaking on December 7, 1965, at the launch of the Italian edition of the encyclopedic collective volume of sixty contributions edited by Guilherme Baraúna on *Lumen gentium*, at which de Lubac spoke on how the Council's two dogmatic constitutions must be the bases of postconciliar reform and renewal (2:483). The substance of the conference came out in de Lubac's eloquent "*Liminaire*," in *L'Église de Vatican II*, ed. Guilherme Baraúna and Yves Congar, 3 vols. (Paris, 1967), 2:25–31.

²⁶In Rome, on September 11, 1965, he spoke at the International Thomistic Congress, on "Tradition et nouveauté dans la position du problème de Dieu chez le P. Teilhard de Chardin," *De Deo in Philosophia S. Thomae et in bodierna philosophia*, 2 vols. (Rome, 1966), 2:212–20. When the *Carnets* mention this event, they add that two days later de Lubac took part in a meeting of the Secretariat for Non-Christians where he gave a paper on the absolute character of faith and the principles by which to judge the religions (2:399–400).

²⁷*Carnets du Concile*, 2:82, 89. Study of the inventory of the McGrath Vatican II papers at the University of Notre Dame has not yet uncovered de Lubac's critical comments of June 1964.

²⁸*Carnets du Concile*, 2:132 (first meeting, on September 21, at the French Seminary, with twelve bishops and eight theologians present, where de Lubac sensed a prevailing *faiblesse de pensée*), pp. 141–42 (de Lubac's written reaction, sent before or on September 25 to the group's secretary, Henri Denis, who had summarized comments made on September 21), and pp. 148–52 (notes on the second meeting, September 28).

Finally, during Period IV of the Council, on October 6, 1965, de Lubac consulted with Volk and McGrath on the need to somehow ensure that certain fundamental considerations urged in the *Aula* receive serious consideration for adoption in the revised text that would then be proposed for a vote. With McGrath, de Lubac hit on the idea of asking Professor Joseph Ratzinger, who combined competence with congeniality, for his involvement in the redaction. This led to new accents in what is now *Gaudium et spes*, no. 10, especially its concluding confession of Jesus Christ as “the key, the center, and the purpose of the whole of human history.”²⁹

3. De Lubac’s Criticism of Currents in and around the Council

The *Carnets du Concile* help toward understanding one aspect of Catholic theology in last third of the twentieth century: the wave of criticism and laments voiced by some leading theologians (de Lubac, von Balthasar, Louis Bouyer, Daniélou, and Ratzinger) over a wide swath of post-Vatican II phenomena.³⁰ The *Carnets* of Council Periods III and IV, 1964–65, witness to de Lubac’s critical turn, as he wrote negative evaluations of allegedly progressive ideas circulating at the Council, along with premonitions of coming theological decline in spite of the fine teaching of Vatican II’s main texts.³¹ In

The McGrath papers at Notre Dame preserve, in section CMCG 1/02, a copy of the outcome of this work, “Remarques sur le Schema XIII,” mimeographed in eight single-spaced pages, coming from the *periti* de Lubac, Georges Cottier, Henri Denis, Jean Frisque, M. Hua, Marie-Joseph Le Guillou, Gustave Martelet, and Paul de Surgy. Among eight criticisms of the schema’s content, no. 3 reflects the thought of de Lubac: “Un dualisme spontané conduisant à un extrinsécisme du surnaturel” (p. 4), as does no. 7, “Le schéma souffre de l’absence d’une vue théologique ou biblique du dessein de Dieu,” containing the assertion, “Il faudrait retrouver l’unité dans le Mystère du Christ” (p. 7).

²⁹*Carnets du Concile*, 2:431. On Ratzinger’s role at this stage of Schema XIII, I gave details to introduce a text that he composed in mid-October, 1965, and gave to the principal redactor, Pierre Hubtmann. “Six Texts by Prof. Joseph Ratzinger as *peritus* before and during Vatican Council II,” *Gregorianum*, 89 (2008), 233–311, here pp. 246–48, with the text at pp. 291–93 (English) and pp. 309–10 (original Latin).

³⁰Some exemplary titles include Hans Urs von Balthasar, *Cordula, oder der Ernstfall* (Einsiedeln, 1966; trans. *The Moment of Christian Witness* [Glen Rock, NJ, 1969]) and *Der antirömischer Affekt* (Freiburg im Breisgau, 1974; trans., *The Office of Peter and the Structure of the Church* [San Francisco, 1986]); Louis Bouyer, *The Decomposition of Catholicism* (Chicago, 1969); Jean Daniélou, *Tests* (Paris, 1968) and *Crise de l’Église, crise de l’homme* (Paris, 1972); Joseph Ratzinger, “Catholicism after the Council,” *The Furrow*, 18 (1967), 3–23, “Der Weltdienst der Kirche,” in *Zehn Jahre Vaticanum II*, ed. Andreas Bauch, Alfred Glässer, and Michael Seybold (Regensburg, 1976), and *The Ratzinger Report: An Exclusive Interview on the State of the Church* (San Francisco, 1985).

³¹After the Council, de Lubac spoke out in this vein in several works, such as “The Church in Crisis,” *Theology Digest*, 17 (1969), 312–25; *L’Église dans la crise actuelle*

these passages, the *Carnets* document, first, the fracturing of the reforming group of bishops and theologians who at Vatican II led the majority to reject the magisterial positivism evident in the draft texts of 1962. But after this development had reoriented the Council, fissures emerged between exponents of different conceptions of directions to take, regarding both strategy and doctrinal content.³² Second, de Lubac's diary notes give early expression to sharp judgments delivered after Vatican II by influential French, Swiss, and German critics of inauthentic and religiously destructive receptions and applications of the Council.

De Lubac's *Carnets* of June 1964 show an overlap of his reformist views with a new critical concern about where the Council was going. The Doctrinal Commission met June 1–6 to complete several revised schemata that the Fathers would consider during the coming Third Period. De Lubac's June 2 diary entry expresses once again his dismay over the efforts of the antireformist group in the commission, a small Roman "clan" that claimed a monopoly over formulating the faith and convinced some who should know better that they proposed the only orthodoxy.³³

(Paris, 1969); "Problèmes actuels d'ecclésiologie," *Documentation catholique*, 71 (1974), 228–29; and in works from 1974 or earlier published as appendices to *A Brief Catechesis on Nature and Grace* (San Francisco, 1984 [original, 1980]): "The 'Sacrament of the World?'" (pp. 191–234, on texts of Schillebeeckx) and "The Council and the Para-Council" (pp. 235–60). On de Lubac in this phase, see Christopher J. Walsh, "De Lubac's Critique of the Postconciliar Church," *Communio*, 19 (1992), 404–32, which draws on the author's 1993 dissertation, under the supervision of Avery Dulles, S.J., at The Catholic University of America, "Henri de Lubac and the Ecclesiology of the Post-Conciliar Church: An Analysis of His Later Writings (1965–1991)."

³²Joseph Komonchak described this 1964–65 differentiation among important Vatican II intellectual leaders in "Recapturing the Great Tradition. In Memoriam Henri de Lubac," *Commonweal*, January 31, 1992, 14–17, and, on a broader canvas, in "Le valutazioni sulla *Gaudium et spes*: Chenu, Dossetti, Ratzinger," in *Volte di fine concilio* (as in n. 3, above), pp. 115–53. In the framework of the second essay, de Lubac belongs with Ratzinger as critical of the social-historical anthropology of Chenu, perceived as secularizing, and of drafts of Schema XIII, while not sharing the evangelical radicality, especially on nuclear arms and peace, of Giuseppe Dossetti, the *peritus* of Lercaro and mentor of Giuseppe Alberigo. At the congress on the Belgians (see n. 2, above), Jan Grootaers treated insightfully these differences within the Council majority in his paper, "Diversité des tendances à l'intérieur de la majorité conciliaire. Gérard Philips et Giuseppe Dossetti," *The Belgian Contribution*, pp. 529–62. This analysis shows the inadequacy of many conservative versus progressive characterizations of the dynamics of Vatican II, especially those that do not look carefully beyond Periods I and II of 1962–63.

³³*Carnets du Concile*, 2:69–70, about Ottaviani; Michael Browne, O.P.; Pietro Parente; Frane Franic; Rosaire Gagnebet, O.P.; Dino Staffa; Ugo Lattanzi; and similar individuals: "Nothing is more demoralizing than to see up close their spiritual and intellectual mediocrity" (p. 70). The danger is that bishops who oppose them take on a

But at the same time, de Lubac's criticism turned in another direction. On June 5, he circulated observations on the current draft of Schema XIII, on the church in the modern world, with an attached letter of warning that the text should not encourage an "opening to the world" that would let believers be invaded by the world and then attend to secular concerns in such a way as to neglect truths of faith about human existence. In his view, the schema was too reticent on God as man's final happiness. Revisions should state from the beginning the Christian faith about human beings: "A few words would suffice. The eternal and divine vocation of man should be emphasized." The schema would thereby make it possible to take up the world's problems—family life, culture, economic and political life, and world peace—in the light of mankind's true human destiny and according to the Church's proper mission, but it must take care to avoid an opening toward the secularization of Christian life.³⁴

In September 1964, just before de Lubac went to Rome for the Council's Period III, a diary entry notes that since the previous winter he has noted signs of doctrinal ambiguity and even anarchy breaking out under cover of slogans about the Church's opening herself to the world. In de Lubac's view, some individuals speak and write about profoundly transforming theological teaching, but upon closer examination their aim is to suppress dogmas of Christian faith. In Rome, de Lubac contributed (as noted above) to the French seminar on Schema XIII and wrote on September 24 that the text engendered confusion and impeded a robust assurance about the word of God and its truth. His entry the next day includes his letter to Henri Denis, the seminar convener, with the lament that in seeking common cause with unbelievers concerning the world the new text distances human beings from their true identity: "If we are not convinced *a priori*, by an outlook of faith, about a pre-established harmony between revelation in Christ taken in its fullness and the hidden expectation planted by God in the depths of the human person of every age, we will lack the apostolic boldness that alone has a chance of reaching people of our age." Then, on October 4, he noted what the Brazilian Dominican, Bernardo Catão, told him about how some French confreres had accused Catão of outmoded ideas because in retreat conferences he insisted

revolutionary allure that disturbs the peace of the church. Earlier, as Council Periods I and II were ending, de Lubac expressed his fears to Congar that this Roman group would revise the texts according to their views (Congar, *Mon Journal*, 1:25, November 26, 1962, and 1:573, November 25, 1963, when de Lubac spoke unguardedly about the Romans as "gangsters").

³⁴On de Lubac's June 1964 observations on Schema XIII, see above on p. 555. His words on "the eternal and divine vocation of man," showing that his judgment rests on the one supernatural end of humans, are from *At the Service of the Church*, p. 342. On June 4, de Lubac had told Congar that the present draft of Schema XIII lacked Christian boldness based on the church's assurance of knowing in Jesus Christ "the truth about man" (Congar, *Mon Journal*, 2:98).

on prayer and interior intimacy with God. For Catão's hearers, the new movement was toward concrete, historical human beings without imposing any "idealistic" superstructure.³⁵

Before the Aula debate on Schema XIII began on October 20, 1964, de Lubac wrote a letter about his concerns over deeper misunderstandings of the Council's renewal program. On October 17, he gave the letter to Cardinal Léger of Montreal and heard two days later that the cardinal wanted to speak in the Aula about de Lubac's issues.³⁶ De Lubac pointed out that the Council majority, because of its absorbing need to constantly defend texts against undermining by the antireformist minority, seemed unaware that the Council's proposals of reform—*aggiornamento*, openness to the world, ecumenism, and religious freedom—could easily be misunderstood. De Lubac believed that the opponents promoted misunderstanding when they branded the new currents the fruits of religious indifference, amorphous liberalism, concessions to a worldly spirit, and the near abandonment of faith and morality. In his view, journalists were not capable of presenting the new directions as in fact arising from a "purified and deepened Christian spirit." Then, too, the descent into juridical arguments over episcopal collegiality detracted from the desired spiritual density in several texts that were now being adopted. According to de Lubac, Schema XIII posed new risks, such as engaging the Church with problems of the temporal order so much as to leave "silence or timidity in the schema about the eternal vocation of man," which could abet a turning away from the realities of the faith.³⁷

One troubling idea that de Lubac pointed out to Léger was a theoretical account of the relationship of church and world, "according to which there would no longer even be any true evangelization in the future, since the so-called 'profane' world is already Christian in reality, independently of any evangelical revelation."³⁸

³⁵*Carnets du Concile*, 2:2, 111 (note of September 10, before the trip to Rome), p. 138 (September 24, on Schema XIII impeding the apostolic audacity of Paul in 2 Cor 4:1–2), pp. 141–42 (September 25, with letter to Denis, citing p. 142), and pp. 170–71 (with Bernardo Catão, O.P., whose Strasbourg dissertation on St. Thomas's soteriology was published in the series *Théologie* in 1964).

³⁶*Carnets du Concile*, 2:205 (composing the letter on October 13), p. 221 (letter "sur les interprétations frauduleuses du concile" completed on October 17 and given to Léger), and p. 222 (Léger wants to present de Lubac's ideas in a coming intervention).

³⁷The letter to Léger is in *At the Service of the Church*, pp. 340–41, in which de Lubac says that he presented to Léger a problem "whose seriousness has worried me for a long time."

³⁸*At the Service of the Church*, p. 341. On October 16, de Lubac had spoken with Father Emile Berrard of Paris, one of the priests invited to be a Council auditor, who asked de Lubac's opinion on a theory spreading among the priests of Paris—that is, "le monde serait chrétien depuis toujours; la révélation Chrétienne ne ferait que nous le dire, simple passage de l'implicite à l'explicite, etc." De Lubac answered sharply that this

De Lubac's critical concerns of autumn 1964 came to be focused on a conception of the world as implicitly Christian by God's hidden but grace-giving influence amid the human experience of existence and responsible action in developing the world and society. God's gratuitous nearness and empowerment thus often reach individuals before they encounter the Church, which discloses explicitly God's gracious nearness. De Lubac encountered this conception in Schillebeeckx's lecture on "Church and World," which was delivered at the Dutch Documentation Center on September 16, 1964, and then circulated in printed form. The lecture aimed to give Schema XIII a better theological basis than it had in the text that would be discussed in the Aula beginning on October 20.³⁹ Later, de Lubac heard another lecture by Schillebeeckx, which was not as extreme as the one on church and world, but de Lubac believed it still lacked a dimension of depth regarding genuine renewal in the Catholic Church. However, despite de Lubac's misgivings, he published a critical study of Schillebeeckx's lecture texts only after the Council.⁴⁰

amounts to a betrayal of the Gospel, but the idea was circulating in Rome from a talk by Schillebeeckx and seemed to be favored in the recent article of Marie-Dominique Chenu, "Consecratio mundi," in *Nouvelle Revue Théologique*, 86 (1964), 608–18. See *Carnets du Concile*, 2:218. Chenu says the layperson's task in science, politics, and social promotion is not to consecrate the world, as an earlier schema stated this (*De ecclesia* of 1962, chap. IV). To consecrate would be to set creatures apart from their own finality as a sign of God's sovereignty. Instead, in the Christian economy of incarnation and sanctification, Christians act in faith, hope, and charity to bring creation to its own finality according to its immanent aims and in service of human flourishing.

³⁹The lecture appeared in English as "Church and World," in Edward Schillebeeckx, *World and Church* (New York, 1971), pp. 97–114. De Lubac's critical comments appear in *Carnets du Concile*, 2:218 (October 16, 1964), p. 220 (October 17), p. 251 (October 26), and p. 261 (October 29). The first mention adds the exclamation, "Combien plus sérieuse, plus Chrétien, plus réfléchie, la doctrine d'un Teilhard!". On October 17, de Lubac wrote to Karl Rahner that his opposition to Schillebeeckx's ideas made it impossible for him to serve with Schillebeeckx on the editorial board of the new journal *Concilium*. Again, the contrast is with Teilhard, who would never say that revelation only articulates the implicit Christianity of the profane world. Rahner persuaded de Lubac to delay his resignation from the *Concilium* board, but after reading the first five issues, he wrote to Rahner that the journal was dominated by extreme views not in harmony with the Council (letter of May 24, 1965; *Carnets*, 2:395–96). De Lubac ultimately resigned from the *Concilium* board on November 10, 1965 (*Carnets*, 2:455).

⁴⁰*Carnets du Concile*, 2:327, in an entry of November 18, 1964, after hearing Schillebeeckx, whose forceful speaking style was striking, but "Rien dans son discours pour rappeler les conditions de base de tout aggiornamento vraiment évangélique et catholique." Later, de Lubac added appendix B on Schillebeeckx (pp. 191–234) to his *Brief Catechesis on Nature and Grace* (as in n. 31, above) that begins with problems in the latter's designation of the Church as *sacramentum mundi* and takes up the 1964 lecture on church and world both in itself and in contrast with the final form of *Gaudium et spes*.

In spring 1965 de Lubac attended commission meetings on Schema XIII, during which the interventions of Karol Wojtyła, archbishop of Kraków, impressed him deeply, but he lamented that Wojtyła's positions were not having the impact they deserved. De Lubac read at this time an article in *Commonweal* by Hans Küng, which left him distressed over Küng's superficiality, demagogic formulations, and hostility to Paul VI. As these meetings were ending, de Lubac wrote that one current of thought was taking *aggiornamento* wrongly as a worldliness without evangelical vigor, instead of a cultural deepening that liberates from old clerical narrowness and egotism.⁴¹

During Period IV of Vatican II, de Lubac made no mention in diary entries about the growth and consolidation of the strong Christological texts of part I of *Gaudium et spes*, the Pastoral Constitution.⁴² He was heartened by Father Pedro Arrupe, the new Jesuit general superior, with whom he talked for fifty minutes on October 8, 1965, and who seemed to understand the gravity of the day's spiritual crisis.⁴³ But the critical remarks continued, for example, about the lack of understanding by some bishops and *periti* of the true sense of major positions taken by the Council.⁴⁴ A typical remark of these days was de

⁴¹Appreciative references to Wojtyła are spread throughout the entries from March 31 to April 7, 1965 (*Carnets du Concile*, 2:357–58, 361, 363, 364, 375, 391–92, 394). The first entry is to Wojtyła's view that the Church is present in the world to make the world attend to the "eternal questions," a point seconded by the German bishops Hermann Volk and Joseph Schröffer, but that Philips did not grasp in its depth and importance. On Küng, "The Council, End or Beginning," in *Commonweal*, February 12, 1965: *Carnets*, 2:344–45. On a mistaken *aggiornamento*: *Carnets*, 2:374 (April 5, 1965).

⁴²See GS 10 (2nd paragraph), 22, 32, 38, and 45, studied by Thomas Gertler in *Jesús Christus—Die Antwort der Kirche auf die Frage nach dem Menschsein*, [Erfurt Theologische Studien, 52], (Leipzig, 1986). The Constitution honors de Lubac's concern in GS 41 in characterizing what the Church manifests to people of the modern world, that is, "the mystery of God who is their final destiny; in doing so it discloses to them the meaning of their own existence, the innermost truth about themselves. The church knows well that God alone . . . can satisfy the deepest cravings of the human heart."

⁴³*Carnets du Concile*, 2:435–36. De Lubac told Arrupe that twenty years earlier the Holy Office and the Roman theologians had created a doctrinal desert, which explains the explosiveness of today's outbreaks. On September 10, de Lubac heard Tromp's lament over the doctrinal confusion of the day, which occasioned de Lubac's reflection that opposition to renewal by Tromp and other Romans had made Vatican II's first actions seem revolutionary and is now occasioning *un désordre para-conciliaire* (*Carnets*, 2:398).

⁴⁴A French bishop was surprised on October 25, 1965, at de Lubac's approval of the *modus* adding to *De revelatione*, no. 9, the affirmation that the Church's certitude about doctrine does not arise from Scripture alone. The bishop thought that the rejection of the "two sources" of the first schema led to affirming *sola Scriptura* (*Carnets*, 2:446). Two days later, de Lubac noted the circulation of crude misconceptions of the Council's teaching on the source/sources of revelation, episcopal collegiality, the universal priesthood, and religious liberty (*Carnets*, 2:448). On November 23: several bishops and *periti* are doctrinally incompetent and ignorant of the real situation (*Carnets*, 2:422).

Lubac's reference to the intensified action on the margins of Vatican II by "pseudo-theologians" who leave their mark on bishops who are weak on doctrine and often distracted from the Council's actual work.⁴⁵

De Lubac's Vatican II *Carnets*, Congar's Council *Journal*, and the diarylike letters of Dom Helder Pessoa Camara are vivid texts to read—rich troves of theological wisdom and enduring testimonies from within the event to the great reform effort that was Vatican Council II.

A Sociological Analysis of Vatican II as an Engine of Church Reform

For those with church-historical or theological background and interests, Melissa Wilde casts new light on Vatican Council II. Her study confronts, with the tools of social-institutional analysis, the question of just how the unwieldy body of about 2500 Council members formulated a refashioning of the Catholic Church, especially in the face of powerful Curial officials who were lukewarm about or opposed to most elements of the emerging reformist agenda, whether liturgical, biblical, catechetical, ecumenical, or oriented to elevating the lay-apostolate or episcopal roles in the Church.

Wilde goes beyond a "great man" causal analysis, as she qualifies John XXIII as providing the opportunity for promotion of the reform agenda, but lacking influence in its successful implementation that occurred step-by-step during thirty months of Council action after his death. More important was a distinct movement within Vatican II—namely, the low-profile meetings of single delegates from episcopal conferences who had collegial exchanges on Council topics at Domus Mariae on Via Aurelia late every Friday afternoon during the four working periods of Vatican II.⁴⁶ From these meetings, approximately 1900 Council members, or 75 percent of the Council, received information on and formulated opinions from positions that emerged in the conferences.⁴⁷ It is

⁴⁵*Carnets du Concile*, 2:450 (October 29, 1965). On December 1, de Lubac wrote to Jacques Guillet, S.J., of Fourvière about the urgency of solid study of Vatican II, centering on its dogmatic constitutions, without infection by tendentious readings that would abort the Council's reform and compromise the foundations of the faith. One has to oppose a secularizing program that takes as nonexistent the doctrinal, spiritual, and apostolic themes of Vatican II (*Carnets*, 2: 473). Later, de Lubac added "The Council and the Para-Council," a more systematic appendix C to his *Brief Catechesis on Nature and Grace* (pp. 235–60), on twisted readings of Vatican II's texts.

⁴⁶In "More Light on Vatican Council II," 81n22, I referenced Jan Grootaers's study of the Domus Mariae meetings in *Revue d'Histoire ecclésiastique*, 91 (1996), 66–112, a study enhanced by appendices giving texts of the petitions prepared and submitted to the pope and the leadership bodies by this group during the Council periods of 1962 and 1963.

⁴⁷Wilde, *Sociological Analysis*, pp. 61–68, with a diagram on p. 65 of the connections between conferences in and around the delegates to the Domus Mariae meetings.

common wisdom that episcopal conferences functioned influentially at the Council, beginning on the first working day, when they were designated to prepare and circulate lists of candidates for the conciliar commissions. But Wilde carries this insight further by showing the simple yet innovative mechanics of ongoing information gathering and consensus building from and for numerous conferences by the delegates to the Domus Mariae meetings.

Wilde develops the procedural profile and an understanding of the effectiveness of the Domus Mariae delegates by contrast with the antireformist efforts of the *Coetus internationalis patrum*, which began functioning during Period II (1963) under the triumvirate of Luigi Carli (Segni, Italy); Marcel Lefebvre, C.S.Sp. (emeritus, of Dakar, Senegal); and Geraldo de Proença Sigaud, S.V.D. (Diamantina, Brazil). This trio emerged as authors of letters to Council members urging votes against reformist portions of drafts on the Church and episcopal ministry, which they saw as subverting papal prerogatives or traditional doctrines. But they were generally not effective in garnering enough adherents to halt the reform drive, or later in promoting votes *placet juxta modum*, accompanied by moderating amendments. Their weakness was due in no small measure to their approaches to individual Council members rather than conferences, since they opposed episcopal collegiality. For the *Coetus*, authority in church governance was concentrated at the two poles of the pope and the individual diocesan bishop.

A second major contribution of Wilde's book, based on the Vatican Archives records of emblematic Vatican II votes, is her identification and characterization of four principal groups of Council members: (1) the Spanish, Italian, and Irish bishops of traditionally Catholic countries; (2) the bishops of the northern, religiously pluralist lands of Europe and North America; (3) the Latin American bishops; and (4) the young churches' bishops from Africa and Asia.⁴⁸

While the stability of Italian, Spanish, and Irish church life left few local bishops feeling a need for reform, the Latin Americans faced crises brought to

The secretary of the Domus Mariae group was Roger Etchegaray, who ran the secretariat of the French episcopal conference and as Vatican II began was directed by Cardinal Achille Liénart to make contacts with other conferences. Etchegaray found allies in his project in the two vice presidents of CELAM, Dom Helder Pessoa Camara and Manuel Larraín (bishop of Talca, Chile), and soon had twenty-two delegates participating in the weekly exchanges, including Helder and Larraín representing most Latin American national conferences and two others from FACE, the Federation of African conferences. Wilde gives the stable membership of the delegates' meetings in a table on p. 136.

⁴⁸On the four groups, see Wilde, *Sociological Analysis*, pp. 32–42 and pp. 47–51. The numerical membership of the groups is as follows: Group 1: 519 or 20 percent of the Vatican II fathers; group 2: 633 or 25.5 percent; group 3: 570 or 22 percent; and group 4: 579 or 22 percent.

light by the success in their lands of Protestant missionaries and Marxist ideology. Thus, they were open to reformist proposals—liturgical, biblical, and ecumenical—of bishops from northern pluralist backgrounds. To be sure, the Latin American bishops were not ecumenically oriented toward Protestants in their lands, but they embraced reforms likely to strengthen Latin American Catholics against Protestant and Marxist competition.⁴⁹ The bishops of the fourth group also embraced the reform program as likely to make their churches apostolically more effective by lessening the scandal of Christian divisions and by enabling their churches to take on more easily an inculturated Catholic identity freed from European forms.

A first, unexpected indication of the strength of the northern pluralist reform agenda was the vote taken on November 20, 1962, just a week after the first exchange among the delegates at Domus Mariae. The vote came after a week of general evaluations of the draft text on Scripture and tradition as “sources of revelation.” The motion was to end discussion and send the text to a commission for revision, instead of moving on to treat each of the draft’s five chapters in detail. Sixty-two percent (1368 Council members) voted to halt discussion of the text, which had been criticized as an obstacle to better ecumenical relations *ad extra* and to productive biblical scholarship in the Church. Only 822 voted to keep the draft on the table for more detailed discussion.⁵⁰ Here was a first striking sign that the “northerners” were gaining adherents to their reform agenda among the bishops of Latin America, Africa, and Asia.

This developing dynamic of wider receptiveness to reform proposals was then confirmed during Period II by the vote of October 29, 1963, which, by a small majority of just forty, decided that the Council would treat the Blessed Virgin Mary not in a distinct constitution but within Vatican II’s constitution

⁴⁹Wilde cites an interview given early in Vatican II by Cardinal Raul Silva Henríquez of Santiago, Chile, who lists elements of decline in the Latin American church: shortage of priests, neglect of the laity, worship that is not understood, moralistic and devotional catechesis, and the scandal of wealthy Catholics oblivious to systemic injustices from which they profit. See *Sociological Analysis*, p. 44, with further analysis on pp. 48–49.

⁵⁰Wilde, *Sociological Analysis*, pp. 21–22 and p. 131, with tables on pp. 33–42 showing that the four groups backed ending discussion of *De fontibus revelationis* to the following extent: Group 1 (Italy, Spain, Ireland) 23 percent, group 2 (Northern Europe and North America) 77 percent, group 3 (Latin America) 66 percent, and group 4 (Africa) 80 percent and (Asia) 72 percent. Because the 1368 votes to remove the text fell short of a two-thirds majority, John XXIII intervened on November 21 to consign the text for revision by a newly created mixed commission (Doctrine and the Secretariat for Promoting Christian Unity). For understanding the northern European opposition to the schema, see the critical theological analysis of the text presented by Ratzinger to the German-speaking bishops on the eve of Vatican II’s opening, in Jared Wicks, “Six Texts by Prof. Joseph Ratzinger as *peritus*” (as in n. 29, above), pp. 269–85 (English translation) and pp. 295–309 (German original of Ratzinger’s October 10, 1962, conference).

on the Church.⁵¹ The next day, 81 percent of the members voted to affirm in *De ecclesia* the collegial sharing of the world episcopate with the pope in the leadership of the whole Church.⁵²

Wilde also includes sociologically based accounts of the success of the promoters of the declaration on religious freedom and the failure of the relatively few promoters of a revised teaching on artificial contraception.⁵³

Two observations can add to the factors treated by Wilde. First, a major source of reform promotion at Vatican II was the Secretariat for Promoting Christian Unity, instituted by John XXIII in early June 1960 and made an active participant, albeit on the margin, in the preparation of Vatican II draft texts. Not only was the secretariat headed by the widely respected insider Bea, but it also gathered a corps of capable theologian-consultors from major university and pastoral centers. This new institutional reality at the center served as a channel for desires voiced by the World Council of Churches and the Council's non-Catholic observers. It also brought clarity over several reform goals and was effective in working for them during the early defining moments of Vatican II.⁵⁴

Second, because of the Catholic Church's creedal-doctrinal-theological basis, the institution's intellectuals played key roles in articulating, communicating, and defending the many-sided reform program. The demanding practice of the episcopal ministry by the Council members left many of them uninformed theologically and inept in textual analysis of draft texts based on doctrine. Here the *periti* entered in key ways into the dynamic of consensus building. What the delegates heard from the episcopal conferences of the northern pluralist lands at the Domus Mariae meetings of 1962 and 1963 were largely the views first expressed by *periti* in afternoon episcopal conference study sessions and then appropriated by a conference majority or even unanimously. *Periti* associated with the Curia, the theological preparatory commission, or the Italian or Spanish episcopates received few invitations to present analyses of early draft texts, while large numbers of members were reading and hearing critical disquisitions, with alternative proposals by

⁵¹Wilde, *Sociological Analysis*, pp. 33–40 (tables of votes on Mary by the four groups) and pp. 102–15 (narrative and analysis).

⁵²Wilde, *Sociological Analysis*, pp. 60–62 (the problematic), p. 64 (procollegiality at Domus Mariae), and pp. 70–74 (the anticollegiality minority).

⁵³Wilde, *Sociological Analysis*, pp. 85–101 (religious liberty) and pp. 116–28 (birth control).

⁵⁴Another institutional body that is not covered by Wilde's study is the Commission (of seven cardinals) for Coordinating the Work of the Council, created by John XXIII in December 1962, which functioned as an active directorate over the preparation of revised schemata in 1963, for example, with Suenens overseeing *De ecclesia* and the fusion of "social" drafts into Schema XIII, Liénart covering *De revelatione*, and Döpfner overseeing, although with little success, the revision of the draft on episcopal ministry.

Schillebeeckx, Rahner, Ratzinger, Congar, and others. A band of intellectuals worked influentially, as Vatican II began, to solidify reformist positions, and soon many theologians entered the service of the Council's commissions to give essential aid in drafting revised texts expressing the emerging majority viewpoint and positions.⁵⁵

Receiving and Interpreting Vatican Council II

Gilles Routhier's collection of a dozen essays, all but one from the new century, surveys the impact of Vatican II on the Catholic Church and proposes illuminating approaches to the ongoing interpretation of the conciliar event and texts.⁵⁶ The topics include an account of phases in receiving Vatican II down to the 1985 Extraordinary Episcopal Synod on the Council; contemporary theologies of reception; media-generated expectations and images of Vatican II; liturgical renewal in the midst of a changing world; ecclesiology under the impact of Vatican II texts and the conciliar experience; the Council's moves toward decentralizing church government; Marian devotion after Vatican II; the Council's reception in its phases, areas, levels, and agents; Vatican II's reception in the thirteen dioceses of Québec; a dialogue with Walter Kasper on conciliar hermeneutics; the needed movement in interpreting Vatican II from the genesis of the texts to perceiving them as a corpus; and councils in Catholic history and the synodal principle in today's Church.

The collection is most welcome as commemorations approach a half-century after the Council's dramatic unfolding, which ended the long Tridentine era and began refashioning Catholicism as a world church. Routhier addresses himself naturally to the band of seasoned scholars of the Council, but also to a new generation, which can take fresh approaches to receiving Vatican II with a degree of freedom from the conflicts and turmoil marking the early phase of its reception (1965–80).

⁵⁵I surveyed the many-sided contribution of Vatican II's *periti* in "I teologi al Vaticano II: Momenti e modalità del loro contributo al concilio," *Humanitas* (Brescia), 59 (2004), 1012–38. I returned to the topic in "De revelatione under Revision (March–April, 1964). Contributions of C. Moeller and other Belgian Theologians," in *The Belgian Contribution* (as in n. 2, above), pp. 461–94. A revised and expanded version of the *Humanitas* article will appear in appendix 5, "Theologians at Vatican II," in Jared Wicks, *Doing Theology* (New York, 2009), pp. 187–223.

⁵⁶The essays appeared first in a variety of French publications, with the exception of "Vatican II: The First Stage of an Unfinished Process of Reversing the Centralized Government of the Catholic Church," *The Jurist*, 64 (2004), 247–83. Related works by the author include *La réception d'un concile* (Paris, 1993) and *L'Église canadienne et Vatican II* (Saint-Laurent, 1997). He edited *Vatican II au Canada: enracinement et réception* (Saint-Laurent, 2001) and *Réceptions de Vatican II. Le Concile au risque de l'histoire et des espaces humains* (Leuven, 2004). Routhier contributed as well the engaging account "Léger et Suenens: les relations difficiles de deux princes de l'Église," *The Belgian Contribution* (as in n. 2, above), pp. 325–57.

The ecclesiolgologist of Laval in Quebec defines *reception* as the process by which an ecclesial subject—above all, a local church—appropriates to itself, assimilates, and integrates into its life an outside spiritual gift, determining the gift's place in its own life. The process is less the passing on of new norms of practice than the stirring of participation in a mentality that draws on fresh sources of self-understanding and action.⁵⁷ In another passage, the “spiritual gift” gains in precision, for its assimilation entails less the modernization of institutional aspects than deep conversion and reform on the part of the receiving corporate subject, which the Council calls to be a more transparent sign of God's saving presence in the world.⁵⁸ Another key element in reception appeared in the author's diagnosis that the churchwide reception of Vatican II in worship and catechesis has only in part shaped the new spirituality needed to ground deeply the Council's renewal of religious life, ministry, mission, and lay service in the world. The needed period of incubation was cut short by the cultural turmoil that affected the Western world in the late 1960s and throughout the 1970s, when the conciliar refashioning was just starting to shape understandings and foster new spiritual vigor.⁵⁹ On Vatican II in Quebec, Routhier makes a point of much wider application—namely, that initial changes in worship and instruction were not matched by a deeper renewal from the biblical, patristic, and liturgical sources. The Vatican II refashioning took place in a Church long centered on Catholic practices but unaccustomed to deeper study and reflection.⁶⁰

Considering reception more deeply, Routhier points out that in the midst of all that is proposed by Vatican II there are key elements, admittedly brief and scattered, that provide an environment favoring deep reception of a refurbished identity. The Council does take tradition holistically as a vital heritage, open to dynamic growth amid ever new reception, of doctrine, life, and worship (*Dei Verbum*, 8). The Council contains a doctrine of local churches as subjects of action that are in communion with each other laterally while being one by their communion with the Church where St. Peter's successor is chief pastor (*Sacrosanctum Concilium*, 41–42; *Lumen gentium*, 13 and 23; *Unitatis redintegratio*, 14). More fundamentally, pneumatological perspectives repeatedly break through into visibility all through the Vatican II documentary corpus.⁶¹

⁵⁷Routhier, *Herméneutique et réception*, pp. 90, 139, 255.

⁵⁸*Herméneutique et réception*, pp. 225. In a later remark Routhier recalls that Catholic theology has not studied “reform” in the deserved depth and breadth since Congar's *Vraie et fausse réforme* (1950), which helps explain why so few have taken account of the high demands of the Vatican II program (p. 267).

⁵⁹*Herméneutique et réception*, pp. 27–30.

⁶⁰*Herméneutique et réception*, p. 302.

⁶¹*Herméneutique et réception*, pp. 64–68 and 248. On these elements, the author repeatedly refers to Yves Congar, “La réception comme réalité ecclésiologique,” *Revue des sciences philosophiques et théologiques*, 56 (1972), 369–403, esp. 391–93.

On the question of interpreting Vatican II, Routhier engages in exchanges on the pattern of “Yes, but . . .” with Kasper’s enunciation of principles for interpreting Vatican II’s teaching.⁶² Whereas Kasper proposes an integral reading that avoids selective privileging of particular statements in the Vatican II corpus, Routhier calls attention to the need of a “transversal” reading of the documents to search out the recurrent and unifying themes. The Council’s commissions developed the individual documents for the most part independently of each other, and the first commentaries treated them diachronically in the light of their genesis through successive drafts. Thus, Vatican II did not articulate its own systematic center or cluster of unifying themes. The latter must be discovered by careful synchronic reading.⁶³

Second, Kasper holds that interpretation must not take letter and spirit as opposed but as correlated with each other. But Routhier observes that to divine the “spirit” of Vatican II, certain particular points must be examined. These include (1) taking account of Vatican II’s overall aim of reform and renewal of the Church, (2) drawing upon the intentions articulated in the *relationes* in which the commissions explained their successive drafts to the assembly, and (3) realizing that the documents arose amidst an intense experience of collegial give-and-take within the assembled world episcopate.⁶⁴

Kasper’s third principle is that interpretation must honor the Council’s intention to teach and decree within the tradition of preceding councils of the Catholic Church. Vatican II did not sketch the plan of a new Church, nor did it recover the long-lost Gospel, but it proposed the renewal of an existing tradition, acting in intentional continuity with the early creedal affirmations of the Trinity and Incarnation. To this, Routhier adds in confirmation that a manichaean contrast of before/after Vatican II is ruled out by the ways in which influential movements of reform—liturgical, biblical, patristic—did mark the Catholic Church before the Council. Still, one has to keep in mind the witness given by Council participants to their experiences of breaking with an inheritance proposed to them as “the tradition.” Such dramatic

⁶²Walter Kasper, “The Continuing Challenge of the Second Vatican Council. The Hermeneutics of the Conciliar Statements,” in *Theology and Church* (New York, 1989), pp. 166–76, esp. p. 172.

⁶³Routhier suggests that the following are themes recurring in Vatican II documents: the people of God as participating subject, regard for non-Catholics, respect for different cultures, readiness for and promotion of dialogue, and constant use of biblical themes and terms. *Herméneutique et réception*, pp. 330–33. A later passage reviews proposals on the unifying center of the Council, offered by Giuseppe Alberigo, Peter Hünemann, and Christoph Theobald, concluding on John O’Malley’s early proposal of Vatican II’s interior coherence through its preferred rhetorical discourse—encouraging, congratulatory, dialogical—in proposing doctrine and a reformed practice (pp. 388–99). O’Malley’s thesis has now been fully developed in *What Happened at Vatican II* (Cambridge, MA, 2008).

⁶⁴*Herméneutique et réception*, pp. 334–38.

moments occurred when they accepted, by a large majority, the schema on liturgy as a basic text (November 14, 1962); when they voted to stop discussing *De fontibus revelationis* (November 20, 1962); when they backed episcopal collegiality (October 30, 1963); and when they finally accepted, as basis of discussion, the revised draft on religious liberty (September 21, 1965). As a consequence, Routhier insists, interpretations have to take account of terms, themes, and affirmations on which the Vatican II documents intentionally observe a respectful silence. For this central step in interpretation, one must ferret out of the *Acta Synodalia* the initially prepared schemata of 1962–63 to identify and evaluate what was set aside as Vatican II developed its texts of renewed Catholic teaching and practice.⁶⁵

Routhier wrote the conclusion of his essay collection in late summer 2005, just after TV coverage of Pope Benedict XVI's meeting with the youth of the world at Cologne, where the pope celebrated a liturgy that would have been inconceivable in 1960. Further, at Cologne the pope met Protestants and a Jewish delegation for exchanges that today seem customary, but only because of Vatican II. Many of the young people who greeted Benedict are influenced by new spiritual movements that have taken up with gusto *Dei Verbum's* proposals on Scripture reading and a prayerful *lectio divina* in daily life. Even before it completed its Constitution on Divine Revelation, the Council itself expressed what it came to teach through the daily rite of "enthroning" and leaving open the book of the Gospels before the assembly as it prepared to enter deliberations and voting on schemata and documents.

Engaged reflection on an adequate interpretation and churchwide reception of Vatican II, as practiced by Routhier, is not a flight from issues of the day in 2009. This Council still has immense potential, when rightly interpreted and received, both in shaping the personal lives of Catholics and in maintaining the ongoing cultural and even political significance of the Catholic Church in today's world.⁶⁶

⁶⁵*Herméneutique et réception*, pp. 339–41 and 346–52.

⁶⁶See Massimo Faggioli's pertinent remarks on the Vatican II Church as perceived and able to act in the global public domain in "Vatican II Comes of Age," *The Tablet*, April 11, 2009, 16–17.